

Week 4 Homework

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In order to receive full credit problems and solutions must be clearly written and presented neatly. In writing up your solution, you should state the problem as explaining the solution. Merely giving answers to exercises will not be enough to receive credit. Your write up must show work and convince me that you understand the material. If you need additional time to complete this assignment, please email me. Starred (*) proof problems are eligible for inclusion in the proof portfolio assignment.

4.1 Exercises

4.1.1 Exercise

Do research on the Pigeonhole Principle. State it, and give two examples of how it can be used to solve a counting problem. Are there other historical names for this counting principle?

4.1.2 Exercise

Many ways are there for 8 different men and 5 different women to stand in a line so that no two women stand next to each other? What is the answer if there are 10 men and 6 women? What is the answer if there are m men and w women with $m \geq w$? How does the answer change if you cannot tell the men apart and you cannot tell the women apart, for example if the people were replaced by mannequins.

4.1.3 Exercise

A **diagonal** of a polygon is a line joining two nonadjacent vertices. How many diagonals does a hexagon have? What about an octagon? What about an n -gon?

4.1.4 Exercise

Suppose you have 10 points in the plane with no three collinear. How many different line segments are formed by joining pairs of these points? How many different triangles are formed by these line segments? If A is one of the 10 points, how many of the triangles formed by the line segments have A as a vertex?

4.1.5 Exercise

Find the definition of a multinomial coefficient. How is it related to binomial coefficients? What can a multinomial coefficient be used to count? Give examples of counting with multinomial coefficients.

4.1.6 Exercise

How many different strings can be made from the letters in the word PEPPERCORN when all the letters are used? How many of the strings start and end with the letter P? How many strings have 3 consecutive Ps?

4.1.7 Exercise

How many length 9 bit strings are there which:
Start with the sub-string 101?
Have weight 5 (i.e., contain exactly five 1's) and start with the sub-string 101?
Have weight 5 and either start with 101 or end with 11 (or both)?

4.1.8 Exercise

How many bit strings of length 10 are there with exactly 4 ones? How many bit strings are there of length 13 are there with exactly 7 ones? How many bit strings of length n are there with exactly k ones?

4.2 Proofs

4.2.1 Proof

Use mathematical induction to show that 21 divides $4^{n+1} + 5^{2n-1}$ for any positive integer n

4.2.2 Proof

Geometric sequence: Use induction to prove that for any real numbers a and r ,

$$\sum_{i=0}^n a \cdot r^i = \frac{a(1 - r^{n+1})}{1 - r}.$$

4.2.3 Proof

Arithmetic sequence: Use induction to prove that for any real numbers a and r ,

$$\sum_{i=0}^n (a + i \cdot r) = \frac{n+1}{2} (2a + n \cdot r).$$

4.2.4 Proof

Use induction to prove that $8^n - 3^n$ is divisible by 5 for all integers $n \geq 1$. Hint: This is equivalent to showing $8^n - 3^n = 5k$ for some integer k .

4.2.5 Proof

Use induction to prove that $n! \geq 2^{n-1}$ for all integers $n \geq 1$.

4.2.6 Proof

Use induction to prove that $1 + 3 + 3^2 + \cdots + 3^n = (3^{n+1} - 1)/2$.

4.2.7 Proof

Prove by induction that $3^n + 7^n - 2$ is divisible by 8 for all positive integers n . Hint: This is equivalent to showing $3^n + 7^n - 2 = 8k$ for some integer k .

4.2.8 Proof

Prove $2^n > n^3$ for $n \geq 10$.

4.2.9 Proof

Prove $n^2 \geq 2n + 3$ for $n \geq 3$.

4.2.10 Proof

Prove $2^n > n^2$ for $n \geq 5$.

4.2.11 Proof

By experimenting with small values of n , guess a formula for the given sum,

$$\frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \cdots + \frac{1}{n(n+1)};$$

then use induction to prove your formula.

4.2.12 Proof *

Bernoulli's inequality: Prove that if $h > -1$, then $1 + nh \leq (h + 1)^n$ for all non-negative integers n .

4.2.13 Proof *

Use induction to prove that $n^2 + n + 1$ is odd for every integer n .

4.2.14 Proof *

Prove by induction that

$$\frac{1 \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdots (2n-1)}{2 \cdot 4 \cdot 6 \cdots (2n)} \leq \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}}$$

for n a positive integer.

4.2.15 Proof *

Prove that for $n \geq 2$, the maximum number of points of intersection of n distinct lines in the plane is $n(n-1)/2$